

CHARLES CRUZ

Senior Photo Editor / E-Commerce Retoucher

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PROFILE

Senior e-commerce photo editor and Head Photo Retoucher with full-time paid retouching experience since 2021, specializing in high-volume product, fashion, lifestyle, model, flatlay, and commercial marketing imagery. Advanced Photoshop retoucher with strong color correction, cleanup, compositing, masking, image optimization, and quality control experience across large asset sets. Known for protecting brand consistency, improving production workflows, and delivering polished web, social, campaign, and e-commerce imagery under tight timelines in remote-ready collaborative environments.

CURRENT ROLE

Rockstar Original / Starship LLC, Los Angeles, CA

Head Photo Retoucher

November 2022 - Present

- Own high-volume e-commerce post-production for model, product, lifestyle, flatlay, editorial, composite, color, skin, clipping/pathing, and batch-production imagery.
- Serve as final quality control and approval point before imagery is delivered or uploaded, maintaining brand consistency across Men's, Women's, and Kids categories.
- Retouch and prepare product and lifestyle assets for e-commerce, campaign, social, and marketing use with attention to color accuracy, natural cleanup, garment polish, and platform-ready output.
- Created the company's retouching SOP, establishing repeatable standards for consistency, image quality, turnaround pace, and production handoff.
- Developed Photoshop actions, droplets, batch exports, naming systems, and production workflows that improve consistency and reduce repetitive editing friction.
- Built a Google Drive-backed file-recall and naming system to improve asset retrieval, version tracking, backup discipline, and image organization.
- Manage the daily retouching queue in close partnership with the Lead Photographer, balancing urgent requests, bandwidth, delivery timing, and production flow.
- Assist with QC for outsourced retouching work when external support is used, protecting internal quality standards and visual direction.
- Built RetouchMC, a custom Swift-based production controller supporting Photoshop workflows, droplets, batch exports, folder automation, naming automation, Google Drive scripts, shoot tracking, and production visibility.
- Used AI-assisted coding and prompting to improve production automation, including export scripting that removed finite recorded-action limits.

SUPPORTING EXPERIENCE

Miss Lola, Pico Rivera, CA

Photo Editor / Retoucher

May 2021 - November 2022

- Executed large-scale product and model retouching for e-commerce and social platforms.
- Maintained strict turnaround times while preserving color consistency, product accuracy, and brand cohesion.
- Built a full-time e-commerce retouching foundation across product, model, and platform-ready output.

Freelance, Los Angeles, CA

Photographer / Retoucher

August 2019 - Present

- Capture editorial, portrait, and event photography with attention to lighting, composition, subject direction, and final image intent.
- Perform post-production in Adobe Lightroom Classic and Photoshop, including color correction, cleanup, compositing support, and final image preparation.
- Apply hands-on photography experience to strengthen retouching decisions across capture, edit, brand presentation, and delivery.

Drones Made Easy, San Diego, CA

Sales and Content Manager

2017 - 2020

- Designed branding and marketing assets including packaging, labels, product visuals, and social media graphics.
- Managed digital presence through content planning, product messaging, analytics, and customer-facing sales support.

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

La Jolla Learning Works, Video Editor (Contract), October 2019 - December 2019 - Edited educational video content with emphasis on pacing, clarity, graphic integration, color consistency, and visual polish.

West Covina High School, Graphic Designer (Contract), 2007-2008 - Created motion and static graphics for student and school-related video productions.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Adobe Photoshop, Lightroom Classic, Wacom, color correction, color matching, image optimization, product retouching, lifestyle imagery, skin cleanup, liquify, compositing, garment cleanup, product cleanup, clipping/pathing, frequency separation, masking, batch processing, Photoshop actions, droplets, workflow automation, file governance, Google Drive workflows, AI-assisted coding, prompt generation, Adobe Illustrator, InDesign, Premiere Pro, web design, CMS, social media assets, UI design, typography.

EDUCATION & MILITARY

Associate of Science in Advertising - Art Institute of California, San Diego, 2016-2018

High School Diploma - West Covina High School, West Covina, CA, 2004-2007

United States Navy, San Diego, CA - E4 Petty Officer, 2012-2016. Supervised safety and administrative management for over 200 personnel while maintaining compliance, documentation accuracy, and operational readiness.